56,000 km long and has a maximum width of 800–1,500 km.

Ocean trench

The long, narrow, steep-sided depressions formed by tectonic forces beneath the abyssal plain are called Ocean trenches. Oceanic trenches actually extend 3 to 4 km below the level of the abyssal plain. There are 26 oceanic trenches in the world: 22 in the Pacific Ocean, 3 in the Atlantic Ocean and only one in the Indian Ocean. The Challenger Deep in the Mariana Trench, (10,994 m) in the Pacific Ocean is the deepest part of the earth. A trench forms along the convergent boundary where one plate subducts below the other (Figure 5.9).

Island

An island is a landmass surrounded by water on all sides. Islands may be formed on the continental shelf or as oceanic islands. Most of the oceanic islands are volcanic in origin. Group of islands

Major Ocean Trenches of the world

S. No	Name of the Trench	Location	Depth (in Metres)
1.	Challenger in Mariana Trench	North Pacific Ocean	10,994
2.	Aldrich or Tonga Trench	South Pacific Ocean	10,882
3.	Kurile Trench	North Pacific Ocean	10,554
4.	Tizar Romanche Trench	South Atlantic Ocean	7,761
5.	Sunda Trench	East of Indian Ocean	7,450

Source: Geology.com

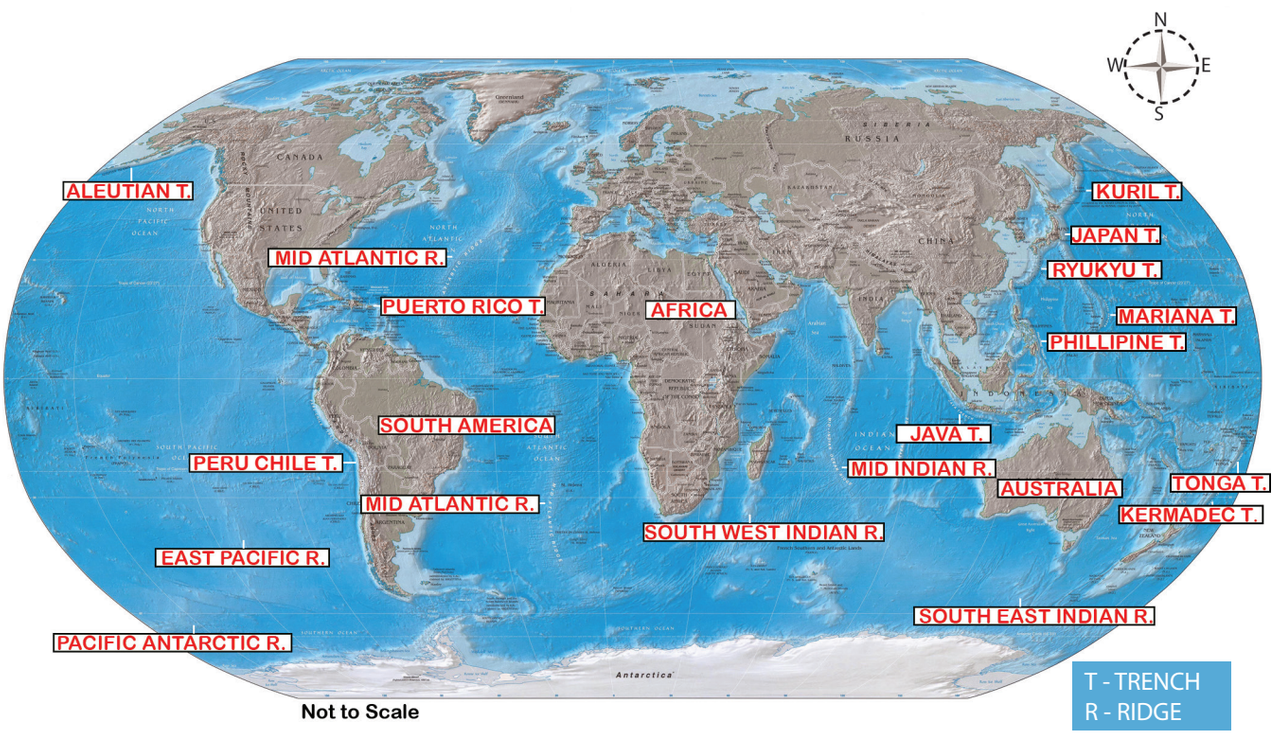


Figure 5.9 Ridges and Trenches of the world

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